

serving time in jail for unknown reasons. He is busted out by his good friend, Dominic Santiago, as an underground alien race has started to invade a fictional Earth-like planet called Sera. As always, the fate of the human race rests on the mighty broad shoulders of Fenix and Santiago.

The game was the first to popularise the ‘over-the-shoulder’ camera angle, which is a bit of a mash-up between first-person and third-person shooters. It also introduced an innovative cover-based gameplay, which has since been used extensively in a lot of titles across the board.

The *Unreal 3* engine shines throughout *GoW* as you are hit by one awe-inspiring visual after another, making for one of the most gorgeous games you will ever see. The character art, the background, the lighting – *GoW* sets the benchmark very, very high and all games following it on the *Unreal 3* engine have suffered.

The plot and storyline, of course, remain simplistic. This game is not about weaving an interesting story and voice-actors delivering award-winning performances; *Gears of War* has no pretensions about being the video game world’s equivalent of a Schwarzenegger movie, and in fact, is a lot more fun!

The co-operative gameplay is the highlight of the title as the game is best played with a friend. This can be done by logging online or through a split-screen mode, as one player controls Fenix while the other takes charge of Santiago.

*Gears of War* also flexes its muscle in the gore department by being unafraid to come up with a lot of gruesome and violent ways of depicting death. Even before its launch, the game became famous for its machine guns with chainsaw attachments, enabling you to cut through the enemy aliens at close quarters as the blood splashed on the screen!

The game’s sequel, *Gears of War 2*, also brought the same amount of intense action along with the all-new ability to control vehicles and turrets. A few new guns were introduced, as was the ability to pick up downed enemies to use as shields. And the best part? Chainsaw duels!

The two games are immensely entertaining and would appeal to almost anyone who wanted a mindless shoot-’em-up with brilliant gameplay and awesome graphics. Don’t miss out on this one...

### Lost Odyssey

While the world of video games is mostly seen as an entertainment industry, it is the Japanese who have always insisted on taking it as a medium of art. Story-telling is an integral part of most games developed in Japan, and especially role-playing

